U23AD491 – DATA SCIENCE

DS Sprint – Skill Based Assessment 2

Course Outcomes

CO3	Utilize data analytics techniques and perform predictive modelling for data-driven decision making.
CO4	Apply data pre-processing, EDA and feature engineering techniques to improve data quality and model performance.
CO5	Use Microsoft Excel and Python libraries (NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn) to analyse data, create visualizations and derive meaningful insights.

Assessment Rubrics

Total Marks : 100

Round	Assessment Stage	Activities to Perform	Expected Output / Evidence	Marks
1	Quiz	• Answer multiple choice questions. • Questions from data analytics, pre-processing, EDA, feature engineering, Excel and Python libraries.	✓ Completed MCQ test. ✓ Score sheet.	20
2	EDA and Feature Engineering	• Load and understand the dataset. • Handle missing values and outliers. • Perform exploratory data analysis. • Create and encode new features. • Apply feature selection or dimensionality reduction.	Cleaned dataset. EDA visualizations (distribution plots, correlation, trends etc.). Engineered features. Feature selection or dimensionality reduction results.	30
3	Data Analysis Using Excel	• Clean and format data in Excel. • Use statistical functions. • Create charts and graphs. • Prepare Pivot Tables and Pivot Charts.	Well organized Excel file. Statistical analysis results. Charts, graphs and Pivot Table/Pivot Chart.	30
4	Pitching Business Insights	• Present key findings from your analysis. • Explain important patterns, trends and insights. • Provide data driven recommendations.	Presentation slides. Clear explanation of analysis results. Business insights and recommendations.	20



Marks Distribution

Round	Assessment Stage	Marks	Percentage
1	Quiz	20	20%
2	EDA and Feature Engineering	30	30%
3	Data Analysis Using Excel	30	30%
4	Pitching Business Insights	20	20%
Total		**100**	**100%**

USE CASE 13 - DIGITAL PAYMENT INSIGHT

Understand Transactions. Detect Unusual Patterns. Improve Monitoring.

Organization	**PaySphere FinTech Pvt. Ltd.**
Sector	**FinTech**

Business Context

PaySphere processes digital payments and wants to understand transaction behaviour and unusual activity patterns using anonymized operational data.

Business Question

Which transaction patterns differ from normal customer behaviour and deserve operational review?

Dataset Description

File	Key Fields
transactions.csv	time, amount, merchant category, channel
customers.csv	customer segment, region, tenure
devices.csv	device type, new-device flag
merchants.csv	merchant category, region
alerts.csv	review status, reason category

Data Quality Conditions

- Missing merchant categories
- Duplicate transaction IDs
- Inconsistent channel labels
- Extreme amounts
- Incomplete device history

ROUND 1 - QUIZ | 20 MARKS

- Answer objective questions from data analytics, data pre-processing, EDA, feature engineering, Microsoft Excel, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib and Seaborn.

Expected Evidence: Completed MCQ test and score sheet.

ROUND 2 - EDA AND FEATURE ENGINEERING | 30 MARKS

- Load and understand the datasets.
- Check data types, missing values, duplicate records and unusual values.
- Clean and combine the data at a suitable analysis level.
- Perform descriptive analysis and create meaningful visualizations.
- Study important relationships, patterns and trends.
- Encode categorical variables where required.
- Create meaningful new features.
- Apply feature selection or dimensionality reduction when appropriate.

Use-Case-Specific Analytical Questions

- What are normal amount ranges by segment?
- Which hours show unusual volume?
- How do new devices differ from known devices?
- Which merchant categories show more alerts?
- Which regions have unusual spikes?
- What patterns appear before manual review?

Expected Evidence: Cleaned dataset, EDA notebook, key visualizations, engineered features and selected features.

ROUND 3 - DATA ANALYSIS USING EXCEL | 30 MARKS

- Import the cleaned data into Microsoft Excel.
- Organize and format the data clearly.
- Use suitable formulas and statistical functions.
- Create charts that answer the business questions.
- Prepare Pivot Tables and Pivot Charts.
- Create one summary sheet containing the important results.

Minimum Excel Analysis

- Amount distribution
- Hourly volume
- Device comparison
- Merchant-category analysis
- Regional trends
- Alert-pattern summary

Expected Evidence: Well-organized Excel workbook with formulas, statistical analysis, charts, Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts and a summary sheet.

ROUND 4 - PITCHING BUSINESS INSIGHTS | 20 MARKS

- Present the most important findings from the analysis.
- Support each finding with evidence from the data.
- Explain important patterns and their business meaning.
- Identify the areas that need management attention.
- Provide clear data-driven recommendations.
- Deliver a short, well-structured business pitch.

Pitch Focus

Recommend safe monitoring priorities for transaction patterns that consistently differ from normal behaviour.

Expected Evidence: Presentation slides, clear explanation of analysis results, business insights and recommendations.

Final Deliverables

- Cleaned and prepared dataset.
- Python notebook containing EDA and feature engineering.
- Excel workbook containing analysis and visualizations.
- Short business-insight presentation.

Marks Distribution

Round	Assessment Stage	Marks
1	Quiz	20
2	EDA and Feature Engineering	30
3	Data Analysis Using Excel	30
4	Pitching Business Insights	20
	Total	**100**